surprised and worried me, but he was placated when I agreed to meet with him privately three times a week to talk about foreign affairs and I gave him my assurance that no one was about to usurp his role in the administration.

Two nights later, Nancy and I made our first trip to Ford's Theater in Washington to attend a black-tie gala to raise money for support of this historic building. During the performance, I looked up at the presidential box above the stage where Abe Lincoln had been sitting the night he was shot and felt a curious sensation. As you look up there, you can't help but run those events of 1865 through your mind: You imagine the figure of John Wilkes Booth bursting through the door at the rear of the box, shooting the president, then leaping onto the stage and running away before a stunned audience.

It occurred to me that until that night probably no one had ever given much thought to the possibility someone might want to kill the president. As I watched the show, I thought about all the security provided Nancy and me and the children and how different things were now. Looking up at the flag-draped box, though, I thought that even with all the Secret Service protection we now had, it was probably still possible for someone who had enough determination to get close enough to a president to shoot him.

Three days after the night out at Ford's Theater, Foreign Minister Ito of Japan was brought into the Oval Office for a brief meeting to pave the way for a formal state visit later in the spring of Japanese Prime Minister Zenko Suzuki. I told him that our Republican administration firmly opposed import quotas but that strong sentiment was building in Congress among Democrats to impose them.

"I don't know whether I'll be able to stop them," I said. "But I think if you *voluntarily* set a limit on your automobile exports to this country, it would probably head off the bills